

TRIGGER POINTS IN TRIGEMINAL NEURALGIA

Trigeminal Neuralgia, also known as Tic Douloureux (Painful jerking), is defined as sudden, usually, unilateral, severe, brief, stabbing, paroxysmal, recurring pain in the distribution of one or more branches of 5th cranial nerve.

TRIGGER POINTS ^[1]

V₁

- Over supraorbital ridge

V₂

- Skin of upper lip
- Skin of ala nasi
- Skin of cheek
- Upper gums

V₃

(Most commonly involved)

- Lower lip
- Teeth and gums of lower jaw
- Tongue rarely involved

DIAGNOSIS ^[2]

- Thorough case history recorded – White and Sweet criteria
 - ✓ Pain is paroxysmal
 - ✓ Pain provoked by touch to trigger zone
 - ✓ Pain confined to trigeminal distribution
 - ✓ Pain unilateral
 - ✓ Clinical sensory examination is normal
- MRI or CT scans
- Response to Carbamazepine – Definitive diagnosis

MANAGEMENT ^[3]

MEDICAL MANAGEMENT

- Carbamazepine
- Anticonvulsants

SURGICAL MANAGEMENT

- Peripheral nerve injections- Long acting anaesthetics / Alcohol
- Peripheral neurectomy
- Peripheral neurofrequency Neurolysis
- Percutaneous Balloon compression